

Haruni Nzai Randu

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Education

Technical University of Mombasa — BSc, Information Technology

2024 – Present (expected)

Key Modules: Cybersecurity (CIT 4205), Computer Networking, Database Systems, Software Engineering

Skills

- Programming Languages: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, Java, Kotlin, SQL
- Tools & Technologies: Supabase (Postgres, Edge Functions, Auth), React/TypeScript, Spring Boot, AWS (IAM, Lambda, EC2), Vercel, GitLab CI/CD, Redis, Firestore, MongoDB Atlas
- Third-Party & Payment API Integration: Safaricom M-Pesa Daraja (STK Push, C2B, B2C, B2B, OAuth-secured callback/webhook handling), Africa's Talking (USSD & SMS gateways), KRA eTIMS, RESTful API design & consumption
- Languages: English (fluent), Swahili (fluent)

Work Experience

Verve Vigor Limited — Technical Co-Founder & CTO

Jan 2025 – Present

- Context – Joined as technical co-founder to build and scale a multi-product Kenyan startup while completing a BSIT degree, operating at CTO level across engineering, infrastructure, and product strategy.
- Action – Set up cloud infrastructure (scoped AWS admin), led framework and stack decisions (Spring Boot/Java-Kotlin for enterprise backend), drove company registration (eCitizen/BRS) and founder/employment agreements, and directed product architecture across the portfolio, including a third-party payment/API integration layer (M-Pesa Daraja, eTIMS) reused across products.
- Result – Established the technical foundation and governance structure for a multi-product company from the ground up, positioning it to scale across fintech, sports-tech, and health-tech verticals.

Payloom Instants — Founder & Lead Engineer

2025

- Context – Built a Kenyan e-commerce and payments platform requiring reliable, production-grade M-Pesa integration for a full buyer/seller order flow.
- Action – Integrated M-Pesa STK Push via the Safaricom Daraja API end-to-end (initiation, OAuth token handling, callback verification, and idempotent transaction reconciliation), designed the storefront and order flow, and split a monolithic Supabase Edge Function into six smaller functions to resolve free-tier CPU limits and stabilize callback handling; managed deployment via GitLab and Vercel.
- Result – Shipped a working end-to-end payments platform, resolving critical CPU/performance constraints that had blocked reliable STK Push callback handling.

ChamaYetu — Founder & Developer

2025 – 2026

- Context – Kenyan Chama (informal savings group) management needed accessible, USSD-based tooling for members without smartphones or data.
- Action – Built a Node.js USSD application integrating the Africa's Talking USSD/SMS gateway and the M-Pesa Daraja API (STK Push, wallet top-ups), covering wallet menus, session state via Redis, and automated SMS notifications.
- Result – Delivered a functional USSD-based savings group platform; pitched as "Chama Pay" in the Community Impact category at the M-Pesa Africa/GOMYCODE Money in Motion Hackathon.

Projects

TalentGraph Kenya — Football Scouting Platform

Feb 2026 – Present

Tech Stack: Firestore, MongoDB Atlas, React, Spring Boot (planned)

- Context – East Africa lacks structured, data-driven football talent scouting infrastructure.
- Action – Designed a Composite Scouting Index (CSI) scoring system, mapped Firestore collections to Atlas fact/dimension tables for a data-warehousing partner integration, and led the landing page design from a cyberpunk aesthetic to a premium editorial direction.
- Result – Built a working scoring and data architecture now heading into a rebrand and partner integration phase.

CROS — County Revenue Operating System (Concept)

2025

Tech Stack: React, civic-tech architecture

- Context – Kenya's 47 counties lack modern field revenue collection infrastructure.

- Action – Authored a full system architecture document and built an interactive React preview of the platform.
- Result – Produced a credible concept and prototype for county-level civic-tech revenue infrastructure.

Pumzi — Lifelong Health Identity Infrastructure (Concept)

Apr 2026

Tech Stack: USSD/Swahili accessibility layer, health data architecture

- Context – East Africa needs accessible, portable health identity infrastructure reachable via USSD and Swahili.
- Action – Designed the system architecture and prepared a grant pitch for the concept.
- Result – Produced a grant-ready proposal for lifelong health identity infrastructure targeting underserved populations.

Extracurricular Activities & Responsibilities

M-Pesa Africa / GOMYCODE Money in Motion Hackathon

2025

- Context – Competed in a fintech hackathon focused on mobile-money-driven solutions for African markets.
- Action – Built and pitched "Chama Pay," a savings-group payments concept, in the Community Impact category.
- Result – Delivered a working pitch and prototype under hackathon time constraints, later evolved into the ChamaYetu project.